

History

Canadian History
World History





About the Course

This course includes the following topic(s): Canadian History: Grades 2-4, World History: Grades 4-6

About Canadian History: Grades 2-4

Read Canadian history stories from the current history cycle (1800-1900). View images and reference atlases and maps to set the people and events in their time and place. Update History Charts as appropriate for student level.

About World History: Grades 4-6

Through the reading of history stories and biographies, students experience what life was like in different times and places. They are exposed to the everyday experiences as well as the major events from our current history cycle (1800-1900). Students will also view images, reference maps, and work on their century charts and Book of Centuries as part of their lessons.



Placement & Combining Tips

Canadian History: Grades 2-4

History courses are on a four-year rotation. Students should follow the current Alveary rotation. Students in grades 2-4 will take the same course.

World History: Grades 4-6

This course is the same for 4th-6th graders. In grade 5, students may begin their Book of Centuries.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
2-4	Canadian History: Grades 2-4 1 time/week 20 min	The Kids Book of Canadian History Born!: A Foal, Five Kittens and Confederation Laura Secord's Brave Walk I Am Not a Ghost: The Canadian Pacific Railway The Spirit of Canada: Canada's Story in Legends, Fiction, Poems, and Songs Belle of Batoche
4-6	World History: Grades 4-6 1 time/week 25 min	William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter Under the Hawthorn Tree Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
History: Grade 4 (Canada)				
	Canadian History: Grades 2-4		World History: Grades 4-6	



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view

online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

History: Grade 4 (Canada)

Canadian History: Grades 2-4



The Kids Book of Canadian History



Born!: A Foal, Five Kittens and Confederation



Laura Secord's Brave Walk



I Am Not a Ghost: The Canadian Pacific Railway



The Spirit of Canada: Canada's Story in Legends, Fiction, Poems, and Songs



Belle of Batoche

World History: Grades 4-6



William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter



Under the Hawthorn Tree



Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

History: Grade 4 (Canada)

- ∞ [History Charts & Timeline Scope & Sample](#)
- ∞ [Century Chart](#)
- ∞ [Grade 4 Canadian History Chart Prompts](#)
- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 15: History.\)](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



History: Grade 4 (Canada)

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance.



Recap

- Connect to previous lessons by asking students to recall where they left off.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture from the reading, sharing something the teacher remembers, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, teachers might consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading this time) or repeating the previous lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage out loud. When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems like they aren't paying attention.
- Move at the student's pace for the lesson time rather than a particular number of pages. It is vitally important that teachers not try to 'force feed' a student more than they can consume in one sitting.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill requiring the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today. Notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they say about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they

are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note. If necessary, take a break for the day.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you could ask them what they thought about the passage or ask an open-ended question.

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Term 1

WEEK 1 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 1

Introduction, The War of 1812

 Materials: The Kids Book of Canadian History, globe or world atlas

PREP: Print a copy of a map of Canada. You will use this throughout the course.

∞ Map Link: Outline Map of Canada

→ INTRO

Do you know when your relatives came to Canada and what brought them here? Where did they move from? Where did they settle?

This year in Canadian history, we are learning all about Canada in the nineteenth century (between the years 1800 and 1900). At the beginning of this century, Canada was a collection of separate British colonies and was vulnerable to invasion by the newly independent nation of the United States to the south. Yet by the end of the century, Canada was a self-governing country of seven provinces and two territories, with a transcontinental railway that stretched from coast to coast. This class will explore many of the changes that took place during this time.

→ LOCATE

On a globe or world atlas, find England. Find Canada. What ocean do you have to cross?

Find the United States of America. With your finger, trace the line of the border between the United States and Canada.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.31-32 "While the fur traders" - "homes and families."

→ VIEW

Map on p.32: "Major battles in the War of 1812"

Compare this map to a modern map of Canada. What differences do you notice?

Why do you think so many battles in the War of 1812 took place near Niagara Falls and the Great Lakes?

→ MAPPING ACTIVITY

On your Map of Canada, label Queenston Heights, Toronto (called York in 1812), Montreal, the St. Lawrence River, and the Great Lakes (Lake Ontario, Lake Erie, Lake Huron, Lake Michigan, and Lake Superior).

WEEK 1 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 1

The Slave Auction, A Letter from a Schoolboy

 Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ INTRO

This book is about an Englishman named William Wilberforce (1759-1833) who was a member of Parliament, the lawmaking group in the government of Great Britain. The English had been part of the slave trade since 1662. In 1770, out of a total of one hundred thousand slaves a year from West Africa, British ships transported more than half. English considered the slave trade inseparably linked with the wealth and national security of Great Britain. William worked tirelessly in Parliament to change the laws and abolish or get rid of the slave trade. As we learn about this remarkable man, we will also learn about what life was like in the late 1700s and early 1800s, what people were thinking or talking about, and how it was different from our lives today. We are mostly studying 1800-1900 this year, but this book begins a little earlier in 1759, when William was born.

• IMPORTANT DATES

1759 Birth of William Wilberforce

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Term 1

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Map of England

Find Hull, which is a coastal city in northern England. This is where William was born.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.9-17 Beginning - "on their journey."

- How would you describe the kind of family and lifestyle that William was born into?
- How are his life and opportunities different from the lives and opportunities of the slaves we were introduced to in the first chapter?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Links: Birthplace of William Wilberforce & Portrait of William Wilberforce

WEEK 2 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 2

War of 1812, cont.

📄 Materials: Famous Canadian Stories, Spirit of Canada

→ RECAP

What do you remember about why the War of 1812 started?

READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Famous Canadian Stories

∞ PDF Link: The Battle of Queenston Heights

p.139-143 "It was early" - "the United States of America."

2. Spirit of Canada

p.58-59 "The Battle of Queenston" - "know your name."

→ LISTENING ACTIVITY

Listen to Stan Rogers sing his song "MacDonnell on the Heights."

∞ Music Link: MacDonnell on the Heights

→ VIEW

1. Spend some time looking at this engraving of The Battle of Queenston Heights. The original engraving this one is based on is attributed to Captain James Dennis, who fought in the battle. The Americans (in blue) are crossing the Niagara River to Queenston (the right side) from Lewiston (the left side).

∞ Image Link: The Battle of Queenston Heights

2. Visit Brock's Monument at Queenston Heights. You don't need to watch the whole video, but the drone footage provides an amazing view!

∞ Video Link: Canada's Most Imposing War Memorial

• EXTRA HELPING

Watch a Heritage Minute about how the Grand River warriors helped to defeat the Americans at Queenston Heights after the death of General Brock.

∞ Video Link: Heritage Minutes: Queenston Heights

WEEK 2 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 2

A Letter from a Schoolboy, To Cambridge

📄 Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.18-26 "What's the coachman" - "law of gravity."

- What do you think it means that William's mom "was against anybody showing great enthusiasm" (p21) in their spiritual life?
- How would you describe William when he was a college student?

• EXTRA HELPING

This tour of Cambridge University shows the architecture and setting of the school. (5:00)

∞ Video Link: Cambridge University

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→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Photo of Cambridge University in the late 1800s.

WEEK 3 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 3

Laura Secord

📖 Materials: Kids Book of Canadian History, Famous Canadian Stories

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week about the Battle of Queenston Heights?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Kids Book of Canadian History
p.33 "Laura Secord walked" - "in a common cause."

2. Famous Canadian Stories

∞ PDF Link: Laura Secord

p.147-150 "In a churchyard" - "heroines of Canadian history."

- How do you think Laura Secord must have felt on her long walk?

→ VIEW

Visit the monument to Laura Secord.

∞ Image Link: Laura Ingersoll Secord Monument

WEEK 3 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 3

To Cambridge, The Shrimp who Swelled into a Whale

📖 Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ INTRO

When someone says they want to enter public service for their career, what do they mean? It usually means they want to get involved in government. It is important to know a little about the government of the United Kingdom (England, Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland) since our book takes place in England. Parliament is the legislature or lawmaking group. The government leader, called the prime minister, is always a member of Parliament. This makes Britain different from the United States, which keeps Congress and the president in separate branches of government. Parliament is made up of two houses: the House of Lords and the House of Commons. You will read about William's entrance into public service.

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.27-36 "William, despite his" - "said Pitt."

- How do you think most people who knew William Wilberforce would have described him?
- What kind of advantages did he have that allowed him to be elected to Parliament?

→ VIEW

William Wilberforce and William Pitt spent time in college in the Strangers Gallery watching the proceedings of Parliament. This picture shows the Houses of Parliament on the River Thames in London, England, and the

• DEFINITIONS

Chancellor of the Exchequer:

the chief financial minister and, as such, responsible for growing the UK economy.

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inside of the House of Commons, which was built in 1834. In this picture, the gallery for public viewing is on the second floor above the entrance.
∞ Image Links: Houses of Parliament in London & Strangers Gallery

WEEK 4 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 4

Laura Secord, cont.

📄 Materials: Laura Secord's Brave Walk

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Laura Secord from the last class?

→ INTRO

Over the next two lessons, you will read Laura Secord's Brave Walk, an engaging and beautifully illustrated story book that brings this episode of Canadian history to life by introducing young readers to the War of 1812 through the courage of one Canadian.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"'Laura,' James Secord said" - "and up the stairs."

- What do you think life was like for Laura Secord and her family in Queenston? Spend some time looking at the illustrations today to look for clues that can help answer this question.

WEEK 4 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 4

The Shrimp who Swelled into a Whale

📄 Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

The year is 1783, and William Wilberforce and his friend William Pitt are on a six-week holiday in France. Think about what is happening in America. The Revolutionary War is just ending. The French Revolution will take place 6 years later. William and William are going to meet Marie Antoinette, the queen of France, who was executed along with the king in 1793.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.36-42 "They were then" - "soul for eternity."

- What does the title of the chapter mean?

→ VIEW

You can look through the different pictures that show the Palace of Versailles.

∞ Image Link: Palace of Versailles

This video gives an overview of the life of Marie Antoinette as well as some misconceptions about her.

∞ Video Link: The Story of Marie Antoinette

WEEK 5 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 5

Laura Secord, cont.; End of War

📄 Materials: Laura Secord's Brave Walk, Kids Book of Canadian History

→ RECAP

What did you read about Laura Secord last week?

PREP: Read the "Author's Historical Note" on the last page of the book and decide how much information you'd like to share with your students.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

• EXTRA HELPING

Watch a Heritage Minute about Laura Secord's journey.

∞ Video Link: Heritage Minutes: Laura Secord

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1. Laura Secord's Brave Walk
"James,' Laura whispered" - "She had done it!"

2. Kids Book of Canadian History
p.33 "The War Ends" - "hide the burn marks."

- Why do you think the War of 1812 helped people living in the various British colonies to start thinking of themselves as Canadians?

→ VIEW

Laura Secord took her message to Captain James FitzGibbon, an Irishman who served in the British army and was mentored by General Brock. FitzGibbon survived the war and eventually returned to England. He sat for a photo in his army uniform around 1860, when he was in his 80s.

∞ Image Link: Colonel James FitzGibbon

Did you know photographs have been around for nearly 200 years? Initially, photographs had very long exposure times, so people needed to sit very still with an unchanging expression.

WEEK 5 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 5

Oh Happy Day

Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: The Strait of Dover

William is going on another holiday with his family, as well as with his friend Isaac Milner, to the French Riviera. How did people travel in those days? (carriage and boat) Trace their route across the Strait of Dover to Calais, France.

∞ Map Link: Rivers of Europe

Once they were in France, they took a carriage to Lyon and then put their carriages on a boat to sail down the Rhone River all the way to the Mediterranean Sea.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.43-50 (whole chapter)

- What kind of spiritual changes are happening with William?
- How do you think his time with his aunt and uncle when he was a child influenced him?

• DEFINITIONS

Theophilus Lindsay (a known minister during this time) left his ministry at the Church of England to start a Unitarian Church that did not believe the core doctrines of Christianity.

WEEK 6 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 6

The Red River Settlement

Materials: Kids Book of Canadian History, Famous Canadian Stories, map or atlas of Canada

→ RECAP

What did you read about Laura Secord last week?

→ INTRO

While the War of 1812 was at its height in Upper and Lower Canada to the east, a Scottish nobleman named Thomas Douglas, 5th Earl of Selkirk, was working to establish a colony on the prairies to the west, at the intersection of the Red and Assiniboine Rivers, near what is now Winnipeg. Selkirk had received a large grant of land from the Hudson Bay Company and wanted to create a farming community to support many poor Scottish highlanders and Irish peasants, who had lost their homes

• DEFINITIONS

Métis: from a French adjective meaning "mixed," the word Métis refers to people who have both Indigenous and European ancestry. The Métis are one of three recognized Indigenous groups, the others being First Nations and Inuit.

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and livelihoods due to various upheavals at the end of the eighteenth century. This community, known as the Red River Settlement, would come to play a large role in the history of immigrants to the prairies, Métis peoples, the province of Manitoba, and the history of Canada as a nation.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The Kids Book of Canadian History
p.30 "The Red River Settlement" - "centre of Métis life."

2. Famous Canadian Stories

∞ PDF Link: The Selkirk Settlement

p.169-172 "'My Lord'" - "one hundred and forty years ago."

→ MAPPING ACTIVITY

Look at a map or atlas of Manitoba and locate the Red River and Fort Douglas (present-day Winnipeg). Find the Hudson Bay on the same map so you can see the route the settlers took.

Compare this modern map to a map of the land given to Selkirk:

∞ Map Link: Map showing the Selkirk Land Grant in 1811

On your Map of Canada, draw and label the Red River, and mark Winnipeg and Hudson's Bay.

WEEK 6 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 6

The Truth about the Slave Trade

Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

Note: We are skipping the chapter "Amazing Grace" for the sake of time. It is mostly about John Newton's conversion. We would encourage you to read it outside of class time.

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

William was looking for a spiritual mentor and was encouraged to reach out to the minister and hymn writer John Newton. Have you heard of the hymn "Amazing Grace"? He was the author.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.63-71

- Why do you think William was troubled about whether he could still be in Parliament and be a Christian?
- Why would it be so hard for William to change the laws about the slave trade in England?

WEEK 7 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 7

Rebellions of 1837-1838

Materials: The Kids Book of Canadian History, Spirit of Canada

→ RECAP

What did you learn last week about the Red River Settlement?

→ INTRO

How do we choose our government in Canada and in our provinces and territories? Do you think it has always been this way in Canada? Today we will learn about frustrations towards the government in the 1830s, which would eventually lead to the form of government we recognize today.

→ VIEW

Remember that in 1791, the large Province of Quebec was divided into Upper and Lower Canada, roughly corresponding to the provinces of

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Ontario and Quebec today.

∞ Link: Upper & Lower Canada in 1791

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The Kids Book of Canadian History

p.34-35 "During the 1820s" - "given any more power."

2. Spirit of Canada

p.60-62 "In the years after" - "letter R in his pocket."

WEEK 7 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 7

Mr. Greatheart

📄 Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

Note: The reading is a little longer today.

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

How can laws help a society not engage in immoral or sinful behavior?
How else can people help others who seem intent on living an immoral lifestyle? As we will read in this chapter, Wilberforce used his influence for good and not only fought against the slave trade but also strived to make England a better place for all people to live.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.73-82

- Why do you think William persevered through the obstacles and discouragement?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Statue of William Wilberforce

★ TEACHER NOTE

You may want to skip the last paragraph on p.82 that talks about the immoral behavior of some teenagers.

• DEFINITIONS

dissolute: lacking restraint, marked by indulgence

WEEK 8 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 8

Rebellions of 1837-1838, cont.

📄 Materials: Kids Book of Canadian History, Spirit of Canada

→ RECAP

Why were the settlers in Upper and Lower Canada unhappy?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The Kids Book of Canadian History

p.36-37 "Rebellion in Lower Canada" - "Newfoundland in 1855."

- How did the colonies of British North America change after 1841 and again after 1848?

2. The Spirit of Canada

p.63 "William Lyon Mackenzie" - "the day and the hour."

3. The Spirit of Canada

p.64-65 "Un Canadien errant" - "last dying breath."

∞ Music Link: Un canadien errant

• EXTRA HELPING

Watch two Heritage Minutes about the reforms that were brought about by the rebellions in the 1830s:

∞ **Video Link:** Heritage Minutes: Baldwin & LaFontaine

(Parents may wish to preview this one for younger students since it does dramatize a violent scene)

∞ **Video Link:** Heritage Minutes: Responsible Government
Queen Victoria voices her approval of the reforms.

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WEEK 8 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 8

The Duel

Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

If people can't agree on important matters, what might they do to settle their disagreements? In the past, dueling was a common way to settle disputes around the world and in America. A duel is a combat between persons armed with lethal weapons—usually swords or guns—that is held according to prearranged rules to settle a quarrel or a point of honor. You will learn how that dangerous practice was finally outlawed in England.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.83-90 Beginning - "new bride, Barbara."

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Holy Trinity Church in Clapham, England

This is the church where the "Clapham Saints" worshipped together and encouraged each other to do good for their society.

• DEFINITIONS

seditions: describes action of saying, writing, or doing something that encourages people to disobey their government (p.85 talks about Seditious Meetings Bill)

WEEK 9 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 9

Settlers - Canadian Crusoes

Materials: Spirit of Canada

→ RECAP

What did you learn last week about responsible government?

→ INTRO

Have you ever been camping? What do you need to bring with you if you are going to live outdoors? What if you didn't have any stores nearby? What would you use for clothing, shelter, and food?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.76-81 "The first population boom" - "or any liquid."

WEEK 9 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 9

The Duel, A Night of Nights

Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

The year is now 1805. The French Revolution that threw down the monarchy was over. A man named Napoleon Bonaparte had risen to power in France. To the troops he commanded in battle, Napoleon was known fondly as the "Little Corporal." To the monarchs and kings whose thrones he overthrew, he was "that Corsican ogre." Some believed him to be a great reformer. Others thought him a monster. Friend and foe alike, however, could agree on one fact: "Napoleon I, emperor of France and for 16 years master of most of Europe, was one of the greatest military geniuses of all time" (from Britannica Kids). We will read about his conflicts with England.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.90-100 "One morning, early," - "seen at Portsmouth."

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→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: The Battle of Trafalgar

Watch this video that discusses a painting about the Battle of Trafalgar.

WEEK 10 📅 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 10

Settlers - Roughing it in the Bush

📄 Materials: Spirit of Canada

→ RECAP

What do you remember about what you learned last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.82-85 "Susanna Moodie" - "try to grow."

- Margaret Atwood's poem describes Susanna Moodie's experience of two different fires. How does she use repeated words and images in the poem to show the similarity of the two fires?

WEEK 10 📅 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 10

A Night of Nights, Free at Last

📄 Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

It has been almost 20 years since William first proposed his bill to abolish the slave trade in the British Empire. Let's see if he finally has enough votes to pass during a session of Parliament on the evening of February 23, 1807.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.100-108 "The Napoleonic Wars" - "open the door."

- Why do you think he finally got enough votes?

★ TEACHER NOTE

The practice of suttee in India is mentioned on p.107. You may want to think of how you will address that issue with your students. It was a Hindu practice that displayed womanly devotion. Hindus also believed in reincarnation and that what you do on earth gives you better status when you are reincarnated.

• DEFINITIONS

euphoria: a feeling of well-being or excitement (p.103)

• IMPORTANT DATES

1807: The Slave Trade Act was passed

WEEK 11 📅 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 11

The Northwest Passage

📄 Materials: Famous Canadian Stories, Spirit of Canada

→ RECAP

What do you remember about what you learned last week?

→ INTRO

After the Treaty of Ghent (signed in 1814), which ended the war between Britain and the United States, and the Treaty of Paris (signed in 1815) that effectively ended the Napoleonic Wars, Britain was left with a large navy and fleet with much less to do. One new peacetime venture for the British Navy was scientific exploration, and numerous ships were sent to remote parts of the globe, including several ships attempting to find the Northwest Passage through the Arctic. Today we will read about one ill-fated voyage, Sir John Franklin's expedition.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Famous Canadian Stories

∞ PDF Link: Franklin Expedition

p.40-42 "The greatest mystery" - "for another man."

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Term 1

2. Spirit of Canada
p.44-45 "The story of John Franklin" - "back home again"
Listen to a recording of Stan Rogers singing his folk song about the search for the Northwest Passage.
∞ Music Link: Northwest Passage
- How many explorers' names do you recognize in the song?

WEEK 11 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 11

📄 Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.108-114 "But what of his" - end.

- What stood out to you about the life of William Wilberforce?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Memorial at Westminster Abbey

You can look at William's memorial in Westminster Abbey and read the inscription on the statue.

• IMPORTANT DATES

1833 Death of William Wilberforce

WEEK 12 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:

Famous Canadian Stories

Laura Secord's Brave Walk

The Spirit of Canada

WEEK 12 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

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Term 2

WEEK 1 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 13

Life at Mid-Century

Materials: Kids Book of Canadian History, Spirit of Canada

PREP: In The Spirit of Canada, parents and teachers may wish to preview the letter and decide how best to discuss its difficult topics with their younger students.

→ INTRO

In Term 2, we will learn about what life was like around the time of Canada's Confederation on July 1, 1867.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The Kids Book of Canadian History
p.38-39 "The 1840s to 1860s" - "to farm or start businesses."

2. The Spirit of Canada
p.107-108 "Shinguacouse was an Ojibwa" - "pale-faced bad brother."

WEEK 1 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 13

Hunger

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ INTRO

When you think of Ireland, what comes to mind? Perhaps the story of St. Patrick. Ireland is often called the Emerald Isle because of its lush greenery. It is considered an enchanting place to visit.

∞ Image Link: The Cliffs of Moher

However, in the 1840s, tragedy struck Ireland that changed it forever. There was a terrible famine, and many people either died or left the country to go to America. Today, one-sixth of US citizens (43 million) identify their national background as Irish. What was it like to live in Ireland at this time? This book is a fictional account of an Irish family during that time and what they did to survive. It is hard to read about such a sad time in history and all the suffering that happened, but we also read about those who persevered and had hope for a brighter future. The author is from Ireland and has sequels to this book if you want to read more. Let's first learn about the geography of Ireland.

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: Student World Atlas p.82-83 & ∞ Map Link: Ireland

1. In what continent is Ireland located? (Europe)
2. What large ocean lies west of Ireland? (The Atlantic Ocean)
3. Which country is directly east of Ireland across the Irish Sea? (United Kingdom-England, Wales, Scotland)
4. What sea lies between them? (The Irish Sea)
5. What is the capital city of Ireland? (Dublin)
6. Now look at the link for the map of Ireland to answer the rest of the questions. Find Cork in the southern part of Ireland. The characters in this story live in Duneen, which lies in the region of Cork.
7. What river runs through Cork? (River Lee)
8. What mountain range runs along parts of Ireland's east coast? (The Wicklow Mountains)
9. What is the longest river in Ireland? (The River Shannon)
10. Which part of Ireland is generally more mountainous—the east or the west? (The west)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. A Simple History of the Great Famine p.121-123

• EXTRA HELPING

This is a good overview about the famine that sets the context for the book.

∞ Video Link: Irish Potato Famine

History: Grade 4 (Canada)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

2. Ch.1

- What do you think about the different reactions from the men and women that the author mentions on p.2—"the men cursed and the women prayed to God to save them"?

→ VIEW

These are photographs of traditional farmhouses or cottages in Ireland in the 1800s.

∞ Image Links: Traditional Cottages & Inside of Cottages

WEEK 2 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 14

Life at Mid-Century - Underground Railroad

📖 Materials: Kids Book of Canadian History, Spirit of Canada

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week about what life was like in the 1840s and 1850s?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The Kids Book of Canadian History
p.39 "After 1834" - "others to safety."

2. The Spirit of Canada
p.66-68 "There were black slaves" - "the drinkin' gourd."
Listen to a recording of Follow the Drinkin' Gourd.
∞ Music Link: Eric Bibb: Follow the Drinking Gourd

3. The Spirit of Canada
p.69-70 "The Underground Railroad" - "coloured men are free."

4. The Spirit of Canada
(This reading is optional, if you have extra time during the lesson. Parents and teachers may want to preview the story for younger students.)
p.71-75 "Even in Canada" - "'My dearest friend,' it began...."

WEEK 2 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 14

Under the Hawthorn Tree, Nothing to Eat

📖 Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

During this time in Ireland, people used turf to heat their homes and cook their food. Turf, also known as peat, was harvested from a bog, which is a kind of wetland. Turf or peat is dead plant matter that hardens and turns into coal. People would have to go to the bog to cut turf by hand and dry it in the sun before it could be used for fuel. This process will be mentioned in the chapter.

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Peat stocks

This picture shows the stocks of peat that were being sliced and taken from the bog.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2-beginning of Ch.3

p.9-20 Beginning-"her brave brother."

★ TEACHER NOTE

P.10 talks about the death of their baby sister.

History: Grade 4 (Canada)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

- How would you describe the religious beliefs of the family?
- Why do you think the children didn't show hospitality to the woman and her son?

WEEK 3 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 15

Life at Mid-Century, cont.; Logging

Materials: Kids Book of Canadian History, Spirit of Canada

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the readings last week?

→ INTRO

The 1840s and 1850s were a time of great changes in the colonies; as more and more people immigrated to Canada, the population grew, and with it grew industries, but also the need for finding places for people to live and work.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The Kids Book of Canadian History

p.40-41 "Everything east of British Columbia" - "the Oregon Territory."

2. The Spirit of Canada

p.86 "Forest have long" - "their traditional homelands."

p.89-93 "In the novel" - "such risks again."

p.94-95 "Lumbering in British Columbia" - "run the hotcakes raw."

Listen along as you read the words to this song!

∞ Music Link: Way Up the Uclletaw

→ VIEW

Spend a few moments looking at this painting of the Marco Polo clipper ship by the British painter Montague Dawson. How does he show the viewer that this ship is in motion?

∞ Image Link: The Marco Polo by Montague Dawson

• EXTRA HELPING

The sailing ship Marco Polo met its fate in a storm off the coast of Cavendish, and its running aground was witnessed by a young L.M. Montgomery, who later wrote an essay about it for the Montreal Daily Witness (March 5, 1891). You can read her essay [here](#).

∞ PDF Link: The Wreck of the Marco Polo

WEEK 3 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 15

Nothing to Eat, On Their Own

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

Here is a little more background information about the potato disease or blight. "Almost overnight, healthy green fields of potatoes turned black. Prior to the blight, many Irish families relied on potatoes as their primary food source. The average man ate 14 pounds of potatoes a day. Mixed with buttermilk, potatoes provided a nutritious diet for hard-working laborers. Ireland was unprepared for the recurring failure of the potato crop in the years 1845–1849. As it turned out, the crop failure was due to a fungus that was unknown at the time, which is now believed to have been *Phytophthora infestans*. Approximately 40 percent of the crop was lost in 1845; however, it did not lead to famine, as surplus from the previous year sustained the population along with some government relief. The next year's harvest was expected to be healthy and plentiful. However, in 1846, the blight returned to the potato crop in Ireland, and relief from the government in England was slow and inadequate. Soon disease and death spread across the country" (From Great Hunger Museum).

→ VIEW

The potato plant grows underground. Potatoes are grown by planting seed potatoes—sprouted chunks of old potatoes—which form multiple

• DEFINITIONS

draper shop: a dealer in cloth and sometimes also in clothing and dry goods (p.24)

ghile: a Gaelic expression of endearment, such as my darling (p.23)

stór: a Gaelic expression that means my treasure (p.24)

History: Grade 4 (Canada)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

new tubers underground, typically five to six per seed piece. Usually after 90–135 days, when the plant's foliage has browned and fully died back, it is ready to be picked.

∞ Image Link: Potato Plant

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish Ch.3 and begin Ch.4

p.20-30 "The sky had" - "of the blankets."

- How would you have answered Eily when she said, "Sometimes I wonder does God even know what is happening down here—his world is so vast and big?"

- Did you notice some of the unfamiliar words in this chapter—a ghile (p.23) and a stór (p.24)? Those words come from the Irish language, also known as Gaelic or Gaelige. The origins of the Irish language can be traced back to the 4th century AD, when it evolved from a common Celtic language spoken by the ancient Celts who lived in Ireland. When England took control of Ireland, the English language became more common than Gaelic, although some words have carried over.

WEEK 4 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 16

Confederation

📖 Materials: The Kids Book of Canadian History, Born!

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the readings from last week?

→ INTRO

How did a group of colonies with so many differences—geographic, linguistic, cultural, historical, and ethnic—join together to form the country we now call Canada? Over the next few weeks, we will read about the events leading up to July 1, 1867, and see the famous Charlottetown Conference of 1864 through the eyes of nine-year old twins Gabriel and Grace, who are eagerly anticipating the birth of new kittens, a new foal, and a new country!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The Kids Book of Canadian History

p.42-43 "By the 1860s" - "to the Pacific Ocean."

2. Born!

p.2-8 "Dear Reader" - "two buckets of fresh water."

• IMPORTANT DATES

George-Étienne Cartier (1814-1873)

Sir John A. Macdonald (1815-1891)

George Brown (1818-1880)

WEEK 4 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 16

On Their Own, The Road to the Workhouse

📖 Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

Until about 1900, the greater part of the land in Ireland (97% in 1870) was owned by landlords who rented it out to tenant farmers rather than cultivating it themselves. The tenant farmers would grow crops and raise animals on the land and pay the landlord with either money or crops. Many of the landlords lived in England and had an overseer to manage everyday affairs.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish Ch.4 and begin Ch. 5

• DEFINITIONS

boreen: (a narrow country lane (p.35)



Term 2

p.30-41 "All the next" - "to keep hidden."

- What do you think of their decision not to go to the workhouses and try to find their aunts? What are the risks?

WEEK 5 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 17

Confederation, cont.

Materials: Born!

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week about the events leading up to Canada's Confederation?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.9-21 "There was a commotion" - "if you need me, ma chère."

→ VIEW

1. Learn more about the artist Robert Harris, who appears as a character in Born!

∞ Link: Robert Harris - National Gallery of Canada

In 1883, Robert Harris was commissioned to paint a work commemorating the 1864 Quebec Conference, titled Meeting of the Delegates of British North America to Settle the Terms of Confederation, or, more commonly, The Fathers of Confederation. The original painting was destroyed in the Parliament Hill fire of 1916, but a preparatory sketch still exists. His other most famous painting - Meeting of the School Trustees - appeared on a Canadian postage stamp in 1980.

∞ Image Link: Meeting of the School Trustees

2. A clearer view of the circus advertisement.

∞ Image Link: Slaymaker & Nichols Olympic Circus

WEEK 5 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 17

The Road to the Workhouse, Follow the River

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

Workhouses were built by the government before the famine as places of refuge for those who were unable to support themselves, often due to extreme poverty. A typical day inside a workhouse was to rise at 6 am, breakfast at 6.30 am, work until 12 noon, lunch break, and then work until 6 pm. Supper was served at 7 pm, with lights out at 8 pm. Husbands, wives, and children were separated as they entered the workhouse and could be punished if they attempted to speak to each other. An inmate's only possessions were his/her uniform, mattress, and blanket. Once a week, the inmates bathed, and the men shaved. The conditions were unsanitary, and the conditions were harsh because they didn't want people to go to the workhouses unless it was the last resort. However, during the famine, more and more people had no other choice.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish Ch.5 and begin Ch.6

p.41-51 "Eily, Eily" - "happened to them."

- What do you think Mary Kate meant by the advice she gave to the children, "Let nature be your friend and help." (p.45)

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Picture of a workhouse

History: Grade 4 (Canada)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



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WEEK 6 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 18

Confederation, cont.

Materials: Born!

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.22-32 "Because of the great excitement" - "and went home."

→ VIEW

Look at this map of what British North America looked like before the Confederation of Canada. What do you notice that is different from today?

∞ Map Link: British North America circa 1823 map

WEEK 6 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 18

Follow the River, The Soup Kitchen

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

History is complicated, and it is hard to simplify all the conflict that existed between Protestant England and Catholic Ireland at the time. The Acts of Union in 1800 that created the United Kingdom had declared that Ireland, a predominantly Catholic country, would be directly under British rule. Many farms in Ireland were owned by English absentee landlords. The Irish were, in effect, second-class citizens in their own country. This background will help you understand some of the hardships in this book and why England didn't provide as much help as it should have.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish Ch.5 and Ch.6

p.51-61 "By next morning" - "yet another good-bye."

• Did you notice what the old man said to them? He told them to leave as the heathens might try to convert them (p.59). And they were mentioned as strange religious folk on p.57. Many soup kitchens were set up by Protestant groups, and since most Irish people were Catholic, the man was warning the children. The author is showing the tension that existed in Ireland between the Irish Catholics and English Protestants.

WEEK 7 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 19

Confederation, cont.

Materials: Born!

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.33-46 "Late in the afternoon" - "Canada was only an idea."



Term 2

WEEK 7 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 19

Beside the Lake, At the Harbor

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

Note: We are skipping Ch.8 for the sake of time and the graphic descriptions of starvation and death.

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

You may be wondering why the Irish were so dependent on the potato and why they didn't have other crops. "Potatoes are not native to Ireland but likely originated in the Andes Mountains of Peru, South America. In the early 1500s, Spanish conquerors found the Incas growing the vegetable, which the Spanish called patata. They were taken back to Europe and eventually reached England, where the name changed to potato. About 1590, potatoes were introduced to Ireland, where farmers quickly discovered they thrived in their country's cool, moist soil with very little labor. An acre of fertilized potato field could yield up to 12 tons of potatoes, enough to feed a family of six for a year, with leftovers going to the family's animals. By the 1800s, the potato had become the staple crop in the poorest regions. More than three million Irish peasants subsisted solely on the vegetable, which is rich in protein, carbohydrates, minerals, and vitamins such as riboflavin, niacin, and Vitamin C. Irish peasants were actually healthier than peasants in England or Europe, where bread, far less nutritious, was the staple food" (from historyplace.com). Although the potato crop failed, some farmers in Ireland were still growing wheat, oats, barley, and other crops that were exported to England. That is why many Irish people blamed England for not helping them as much as they could have. You will read more about that in today's reading.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9-part of Ch.10

p.73-80 Beginning - "Let's leave it."

- How have the children matured and changed since leaving their house?

WEEK 8 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 20

Confederation, cont.

Materials: Spirit of Canada

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.114-116 "On July 1, 1867" - "the north-west."

- How do you think you would have felt if you were alive back then to celebrate Canada's Confederation? What activities sound the most fun to you?

2. p.117-118 "When the Charlottetown Conference" - "birthright was sold."

Listen to a performance of the Anti-Confederation Song, recorded only ten years after Newfoundland joined Canada in 1949.

∞ Music Link: Alan Mills - Anti-Confederation Song (1959)

History: Grade 4 (Canada)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 8 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 20

At the Harbor, Traveling by Night

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

While many people stayed in Ireland hoping for an end to the famine, millions of people emigrated (to leave one's country to live elsewhere) to other places. Between 1845 and 1855, nearly 2 million people emigrated from Ireland to America and Australia, and another 750,000 to Britain. The Poor Law Extension Act, which made landlords responsible for the maintenance of their own poor, urged the landlords to pay for their tenants to leave the country. However, emigrating was not an easy solution. Ships were overcrowded, and many people died before reaching their new home. Disease spread quickly on board because people were packed in so close together. These ships became known as "coffin ships" because so many people died aboard them.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish Ch.10-12

p.80-88 "Eily and Peggy" - "by day again."

- On p.84 the author says that Eily realizes just how young Peggy is and how brave she is. How do you think this kind of journey will change the children's understanding of themselves and the world around them?

WEEK 9 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 21

Red River Rising - Manitoba

Materials: The Kids Book of Canadian History, The Spirit of Canada

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week about July 1, 1867?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The Kids Book of Canadian History

p.45-46 "Two years later" - "Nile River in Egypt."

2. The Spirit of Canada (optional)

p.109-111 "Willie Dunn" - "which it does entail." You can listen along at the link below:

∞ Music Link: Ballad of Crowfoot

As it is described in The Spirit of Canada, The Ballad of Crowfoot is a "haunting" reflection on how detrimental many of Canada's policies and treaties were for Indigenous people over the course of one man's life in the nineteenth century. This tragic song may be best suited for older students.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Louis Riel (1844-1885)

WEEK 9 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 21

Peggy's Fever, Michael's Desperate Search

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

PREP: You may want to read the PDF titled "How Can God Be Good and Allow Evil and Suffering?" so you can discuss these issues with your student as you see fit. This issue is addressed by one of the characters at the end of today's reading.

∞ PDF Link: How Can God Be Good and Allow Evil and Suffering? (from corechristianity.com)

History: Grade 4 (Canada)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.13-part of ch.14

p.89-97 Beginning - "was a monster."

- Does that last sentence bother you? What would you say to Michael?

WEEK 10 📅 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 22

From Sea to Sea

📖 Materials: The Kids Book of Canadian History, Famous Canadian Stories

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The Kids Book of Canadian History

p.47-48 "One year after" - "he could do it."

2. Famous Canadian Stories

∞ PDF Link: Alexander Graham Bell

p.278-280 "On March 10, 1876" - "the telephone had come."

• EXTRA HELPING

Learn more about the history of "O Canada" by reading the lyrics of previous versions.

∞ Article Link: O Canada

• IMPORTANT DATES

Alexander Graham Bell (1847-1922)

WEEK 10 📅 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 22

Michael's Desperate Search, The Cow, Castletaggart

📖 Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

This tragedy impacted the population of Ireland and the population of Irish immigrants in America. Between the famine and people emigrating to other places, you can see the decrease in population and also how it continued after the famine. The population never again reached the size it was before the famine.

(4 years before famine) 1841—8 million

(During famine) 1851—6 million

(After famine) 1871—4 million

2017—4.75 million

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish Ch.14 - beginning of Ch.16

p.97-109 "Eily kept watching" - "them some relief."

WEEK 11 📅 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 23

The Great Northwest

📖 Materials: The Kids Book of Canadian History, Belle of Batoche

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The Kids Book of Canadian History

p.49-50 "The land bought" - "in November 1885."

→ INTRO

The next book we will read, Belle of Batoche, is the story of a young Métis

★ TEACHER NOTE

Belle of Batoche is an engaging story written in a simple style. It is an excellent option for an independent read for ready students.

History: Grade 4 (Canada)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

girl whose family is caught up in the North-West Resistance, and its final battle in Batoche, Saskatchewan. Belle is an ordinary eleven-year old girl who helps her parents, serves at her church, and is preoccupied with a rivalry with another girl at school when she is suddenly at the centre of the 1885 Riel Rebellion.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

2. Belle of Batoche

p.1-7 "Belle emerged" - "feel very special."

- What are your first impressions of Belle if you were meeting her as a new friend?

WEEK 11 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 23

Castletaggart, Journey's End

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish ch.16-17

p.109-119 "A priest passed" - end.

- What are some characteristics you would use to describe the children?
- What did you learn about the Irish Famine from this historical novel that you wouldn't have learned if you just read about it in a non-fiction book?

→ VIEW

Did you notice all the times the hawthorn tree was mentioned, including the title of the book? Watch this video to see why hawthorn trees are significant to Irish folklore.

∞ Video Link: Hawthorn Trees (just watch 1:54-4:35)

• DEFINITIONS

demesne: the land attached to an estate (p.107)

WEEK 12 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:

Born! A Foal, Five Kittens, and Confederation

The Spirit of Canada

The Kids Book of Canadian History

WEEK 12 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from: Under the Hawthorn Tree

History: Grade 4 (Canada)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 25

Belle of Batoche, cont.

Materials: Belle of Batoche

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.8-19 "Belle rounded the corner" - "let Sarah beat her."

- What are your first impressions of the character of Sarah?
- Read Wordsworth's poem for yourself, and discuss the two girls' interpretations. Do you see the images in your mind?
- ∞ Link: I Wandered Lonely as a Cloud

WEEK 1 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 25

Aliens Arrive

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun, Student World Atlas

→INTRO

This is a non-fiction book that tells the story of how U.S. Navy ships headed by Commodore Matthew Perry sailed to Japan in 1853 to bring a letter from President Fillmore asking Japan to open its ports to trading with the U.S. Other attempts had been tried before but were unsuccessful. Due to policies in Japan, it had remained isolated from most other countries for hundreds of years. Imagine you are living in your small fishing village of Shimoda and have never met anyone from another country. You see four huge ships approaching. That is what it was like for the people on that day in July 8, 1853. Let's first learn about the geography of Japan.

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: Student World Atlas p.30-31, 92-92

1. On which continent is Japan found? (Asia)
2. How would you get from the U.S. to Japan in a ship if you were going to leave from the East Coast? (Sail east across the Atlantic Ocean, around the southern tip of Africa, and across the Indian Ocean and western Pacific in between Sumatra and Malaysia).
3. Which countries are closest to Japan? (North and South Korea, Russia, China)
4. Is Japan north or south of the equator? (north)
5. What is the capital of Japan? (Tokyo)
6. Turn to p.91-92. How many main islands is Japan made up of? (4) Name them. (Hokkaido, Honshu, Shikoku, Kyushu) There are also nearly 4,000 smaller islands!
7. Which island is the largest? (Honshu)
8. What bodies of water surround Japan? (the Pacific Ocean, Sea of Japan / East Sea, East China Sea, Sea of Okhotsk)
9. What physical features cover much of Japan? (Almost four-fifths of Japan is covered with mountains.)
10. Why might Japan's island location have helped protect it from invasions?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1-start of Ch.2

p.13-20 Beginning - "ship to leave."

- Why do you think the title of the first chapter is "Aliens Arrive"?
- Why might they think American ships are not coming on friendly terms?

• DEFINITIONS

turmoil: a state or condition of extreme confusion (p.14)

inept: lacking qualities (as knowledge, skill, or ability) required to do a job (p.15)

• EXTRA HELPING

The Japanese had never seen a steamship. If you are interested in learning more about steamships, watch this video.

∞ **Video Link:** The Story of Steamships (2:55-5:00)



Term 3

→ VIEW

∞ Image Links: Japanese Society & Chart of Feudal System

1. Japan was still based on a feudal society, which means society was divided into strict social classes where everyone had a specific role that they had to follow. Read the description of Japanese society and look at the chart that shows the feudal system and who has the most power and the least power.
2. Look at the illustrations at the beginning of the book and in Ch.1. Then read about the illustrations on p.138. Most of the illustrations from that time period come from either Japanese artists or American artists who were part of the expedition.

WEEK 2 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 26

Belle of Batoche, cont.

Materials: Belle of Batoche

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.21-31 "That night, Belle" - "that she would win."

- What do you think of the embroidery competition? Do you think it is a fair way to decide who will be the bell ringer?

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

This video gives an excellent introduction to the history of Batoche and the land around it. Watch especially for a brief appearance of Jacqueline Guest, the author of Belle of Batoche!

∞ Video Link: Batoche National Historic Site – Batoche and Tourond's Coulée: A Landscape Coming Alive

WEEK 2 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 26

The Black Ships of Evil Men, His High and Mighty Mysteriousness

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

The four American ships full of 560 men of the U.S. Navy have arrived off the coast of Japan, and now we will find out how the Japanese will respond. What do you think they will do?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish ch.2-ch.3

p.20-29

- Why do you think Commodore Perry stood firm on his decision not to sail to the port in Nagasaki or meet with lower officials? (Interesting note: It was said that Perry realized that previous failures had resulted from insufficient show of strength and ignorance of Japanese character, two mistakes he would never make.)
- What are some of the differences you notice so far between the Americans and the Japanese?

moored: anchored (p.20)

History: Grade 4 (Canada)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 3 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 27

Belle of Batoche, cont.

Materials: Belle of Batoche

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.31-43 "While working on" - "that people talked."

→ VIEW

Learn more about elements of Métis culture, many of which are mentioned in Belle of Batoche: Métis sash, Red River cart, Red River jig, Métis flag, cuisine, beadwork, and fiddle. Follow the "Learn More" links under each heading.

∞ Link: Symbols of Métis Culture

WEEK 3 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 27

Landing on Sacred Soil

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Ch.4 p.30-36

• What stood out to you about the meeting?

2. Read the letter from President Fillmore that is found in Appendix A, p.123-124.

• Do you think the letter was persuasive? What do you think about the reasons he gave for opening trade?

→ VIEW

Discuss the illustration on p.32-33 and the details you remember from the reading.

• DEFINITIONS

cutlass: a short curving sword formerly used by sailors on warships (p.31)

pikemen: soldiers with heavy spears with a very long shaft (p.31)

anteroom: a small outer room that leads to another room and that is often used as a waiting room (p.34)

capacious: wide or huge (p.36)

abrogate: to put an end to by formal action (p.124)

WEEK 4 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 28

Belle of Batoche, cont.

Materials: Belle of Batoche

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.44-59 "Belle had to do" - "she didn't think so."

• Are you suspicious of Sarah's behaviour, too? What do you think will happen next?

★ TEACHER NOTE

In order to get through the whole novel, some lessons have slightly longer than 10-minute readings. You might decide to do the extra reading during the afternoon.

WEEK 4 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 28

The Dutch Island Prison, Foreigners Forbidden

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

The only Western country that had been allowed to trade with Japan was

★ TEACHER NOTE

You may want to skip the last sentence on p.39 that tells about the actions of the Dutchmen before the Shoguns.



Term 3

the Netherlands, which began trade in 1608. The Dutch traders were confined to an artificial island and had many rules to follow. You will read about that in this chapter. Then the next chapter will explain why the Japanese were cut off from the rest of the world and how it had not always been that way.

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Map of Japan

Find Nagasaki on the western side of Japan. The tiny island of Deshima was connected by bridge to Nagasaki.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Ch.5 p.37-40

- Why do you think the Dutch put up with all those rules and requirements in order to have a trading station?

2. Ch.6 p.41-43

- Why do you think the Japanese mistrusted foreigners?

→ VIEW

This illustration from Phillip von Siebold's book shows Deshima, the artificial island where the Dutch traders lived.

∞ Image Link: Illustration of Deshima.

WEEK 5 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 29

Belle of Batoche, cont.

📄 Materials: Belle of Batoche

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.60-73 "All the way home" - "cheated in the contest."

- Belle suspects Sarah of cheating, and Sarah accuses Belle of making up stories. How do you think they should work through this conflict? What do you think of their actions?

WEEK 5 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 29

The Great Peace

📄 Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

In this chapter, you will learn more about the Japanese feudal system, where everyone was born into a specific social class. You may want to write the names of the classes on a whiteboard or piece of paper as you read about them and put symbols or words that represent their roles and obligations.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7 p.44-53

- What do you think the basis was for all the specific rules they had?
- How do you determine what rules a society should have and what rules take away personal freedom?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Please note the reference to ritual suicide on p.48.

• DEFINITIONS

vassal: a person who received protection and land from a lord in return for loyalty and service (p.47)

saki: a Japanese alcoholic drink that is made from rice (p.52)

stratified: divided into social classes (p.53)

History: Grade 4 (Canada)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



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WEEK 6 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 30

Belle of Batoche, cont.

Materials: Belle of Batoche

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.74-90 "The sun had not crested" - "bell from the church!"

→ VIEW

1. While reading, consult this map of Batoche and a larger map of Saskatchewan in 1885.

∞ Map Link: Map of Batoche National Historic Site

∞ Map Link: Troop Movement & Battles, 1885 Resistance

2. The attack on the Northcote steamer ship actually happened. Here is an illustration of the event published in the "Illustrated War News" periodical on August 29, 1885.

∞ Image Link: The Steamer "Northcote" Running the Gauntlet at Batoche May 8th, 1885

WEEK 6 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 30

Clouds Over the Land of the Rising Sun, The Black Ships Return

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun, Student World Atlas

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Student World Atlas, p.93

Find Hong Kong. (southeastern China) Commodore Perry and his men went to Hong Kong while they waited for the Japanese leaders to make their decision.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Ch.8 p.54-59

• What do you think about some of the American customs that Manjiro found strange?

2. Begin Ch.9 p.63-65 Beginning - "to read documents."

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview the first paragraph on p.63 that talks about women and liquor and minstrel shows.

• DEFINITIONS

armaments: weapons (p.56)

quandary: a situation in which you are confused about what to do (p.57)

monotony: a lack of change that makes something boring (p.65)

WEEK 7 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 31

Belle of Batoche, cont.

Materials: Belle of Batoche

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.91-105 "Belle looked back" - "shortcut to our house."

WEEK 7 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 31

The Black Ships Return, The Treaty House

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

★ TEACHER NOTE

There is mention of ritual suicides on p.76 in the last two paragraphs.

• DEFINITIONS

retainers: servants (p.69)

History: Grade 4 (Canada)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Finish Ch.9 p.65-68 "During the long" - end of chapter.
2. Ch.10 p.69-77
 - Perry didn't think the Japanese valued human life because of their treatment of the American sailors and some of the Japanese customs. What would it look like if a society valued human life?
3. If time permits, you can read the letter to the President in Appendix B, p.125-126.

→ VIEW

Discuss the illustrations on p.70-73 and the details you remember from the reading.

WEEK 8 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 32

Belle of Batoche, cont.

📄 Materials: Belle of Batoche

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.105-119 "As the afternoon" - "they were fast asleep."

- What are the emergency supplies that Belle goes back home to get? How are they different from emergency supplies that you might pack today? What are some other ways that shelter, clothing, food, and medicines have changed over 140 years?

WEEK 8 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 32

An Array of Gifts

📄 Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

How do you feel when people give you gifts? Perry thought he would try to win over the Japanese by giving them all kinds of gifts that would represent America.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch. 11 p.78-86

- Which gift of the Americans do you think was the most interesting?
- Which gift of the Japanese do you think was the most interesting?

→ VIEW

1. If you are interested, look at the list of gifts in Appendix C & D, p.127-130.
2. The Japanese gave the Americans pieces of lacquerware. Lacquer, a shiny, hard surface, is applied to materials such as wood or metal. Then pictures are painted on the objects.
∞ Image Link: Writing lacquer box

• EXTRA HELPING

One of the gifts the Americans brought to Japan was a telegraph. Watch this short video to learn about this invention.

∞ Video Link: The Telegraph

WEEK 9 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 33

Belle of Batoche, cont.

📄 Materials: Belle of Batoche

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

History: Grade 4 (Canada)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.120-135 "They were awoken" - "Patrice Tourond."

- What did you think of the ending of the book? Why do you think the dangerous days of hiding helped Belle and Sarah to become friends? What changed?

WEEK 9 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 33

The Grand Banquet, The Treaty

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch. 12-13 p.87-96

- Are you surprised by the concessions the Japanese made in the treaty?
- Why do you think they were now open to engaging with foreigners?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Please preview content on p.91 that talks about a minstrel show.

• DEFINITIONS

diplomacy: the work of maintaining good relations between the governments of different countries (p.87)

WEEK 10 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 34

The Canadian Pacific Railway

Materials: The Kids Book of Canadian History, I Am Not a Ghost

PREP: In I Am Not a Ghost, read Foreword (p.6-7) and Historical Notes (p.36-37) and decide how best to share this information with your student(s). This beautifully illustrated story offers an opportunity to discuss with your children what it means to treat others as image-bearers of the image of God.

→ INTRO

The last two classes cover the completion of the Canadian Pacific Railway in 1885, which had been one of the conditions for British Columbia joining Canada in 1871. This project came at a high cost, however, as the work was often dangerous, and the Chinese labourers who were brought to Canada as railway workers were underpaid, undernourished, and mistreated. I Am Not a Ghost tells the story of one temporary Chinese worker whose life was saved through the kindness of one person.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The Kids Book of Canadian History
p.50 "Surveyors and engineers" - "July 1886."

2. I Am Not a Ghost
p.8-22 "Johnny! You!" - "We all healed."

- In the first half of the story, we see the main character being treated very differently by two people: the foreman and Mrs. Douglas. How do they treat him differently? Does this story remind you of any other stories you know?

WEEK 10 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 34

Excursions on Land and Sea, Shore Leave

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Shimoda, Japan

1. You will see that Shimoda is darkened on this map. This is one of the

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview bottom of p.98 and top of p.99, which again mention ritual suicide. P.102 talks about a bathhouse that is shared by both men and women.

• DEFINITIONS

daguerreotype: an early photograph produced on a silver

History: Grade 4 (Canada)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

ports that the Americans are allowed to use. This is also the fishing village that was mentioned at the beginning of the book that first sighted the 4 black ships.

∞ Map Link: Hakodate, Japan

2. Hakodate is circled on the map. Where is it located in relation to Shimoda? This is the other port city that the Americans were allowed to go to.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch. 14-15 p.97-106

- What were some of the differences between the American customs and lifestyle and the Japanese?

or a silver-covered copper plate (p.103)

WEEK 11 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 35

The Canadian Pacific Railway, cont.

📖 Materials: I Am Not a Ghost, The Spirit of Canada

→ RECAP

What do you remember from your reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. I Am Not a Ghost

p.24-35 "After three weeks" - "we are proud Canadians."

2. The Spirit of Canada

p.122-125 "Canada's first public railway line" - "and our toil."

Listen along to the song at the following link:

∞ Music Link: Canadian Railroad Trilogy

• EXTRA HELPING

Have you ever seen the photograph of the last spike being hammered into the railway at Craigellachie, BC? Did you notice the young boy front and centre? See the photograph and learn more about him.

∞ Article Link: The Kid in the Last Spike

John A. Macdonald's wife Agnes had a unique way of riding the train! Read her story "The Lady and the Cowcatcher" in The Spirit of Canada p.130-133, and see a photograph of her from 1887.

∞ Article Link: History Corner -1887- Lady Agnes Macdonald

WEEK 11 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 35

In the Wake of the Black Ships, Afterward

📖 Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

The United States has consuls all over the world. Consuls are representatives of a government who reside in a foreign country to assist and protect citizens of the consul's country and to promote and facilitate relations between the two countries. Two years after Perry, it was time to send a consul to Japan. Let's see if he is welcomed.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch. 16, Afterward

- Why do you think other people were so interested in going to Japan now that it was open to foreigners?
- What were the positive changes that took place in Japan once they ended the feudal system?

pantaloon: loose-fitting, usually shorter than ankle-length pants (p.107)

WEEK 12 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:

History: Grade 4 (Canada)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3	
The Kids Book of Canadian History Belle of Batoche I am not a Ghost	
WEEK 12 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 36 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun	

History: Grade 4 (Canada)

Examination

Term 1

Canadian History: Grades 2-4

· (Famous Canadian Stories and Laura Secord's Brave Walk) Tell the story of Laura Secord. OR (The Spirit of Canada) Describe how the characters in Catharine Parr Traill's Canadian Crusoes were able to survive in the forest.

World History: Grades 4-6

· William Wilberforce-The Freedom Fighter: Tell the story of William Wilberforce's fight against the slave trade and what lessons we can learn from him.

Term 2

Canadian History: Grades 2-4

· (Born! and The Kids Book of Canadian History) What were some of the reasons why the provinces wanted to come together to form the Dominion of Canada in 1867? OR (The Spirit of Canada and The Kids Book of Canadian History) Tell all you remember about what life was like around the middle of the nineteenth century. What sorts of work did people do?

Term 3

Canadian History: Grades 2-4

· (Belle of Batoche and The Kids Book of Canadian History) Tell all you know about Métis culture in nineteenth-century Canada—this can include historical events and/or the Métis way of life. OR (I am not a Ghost and The Kids Book of Canadian History) Why and how did the Canadian Pacific Railway get built? Why was its completion such an important event in Canadian history?